

U.S. HISTORY HACK™

Teacher Graphic Organizer Toolkit

Unit 1 — The Rise of Industrialization (1877–1900) • Reproducible

WHY THIS TOOLKIT

Knowing WHICH organizer to use, and WHEN, is half the battle. This toolkit tells you — with a brief why for each — then gives you reproducible blanks (Part 1) and Unit 1 ready-to-print, pre-labeled organizers (Part 2). Tennessee connections are highlighted throughout; the local-to-national move is a HistoryHack signature and a point of difference for our classrooms.

Which Organizer, When — Quick Guide

Scan the left column for what the activity asks students to do; reach for the organizer on the right. Every organizer in Part 1 also carries its own “when to use · why it works” note.

When the task asks students to...	Reach for...	Why it works
compare / contrast TWO things	Venn (2) or T-Chart	Marzano's highest-yield strategy; the overlap names shared traits
compare 3+ things on set criteria	Compare & Contrast Matrix	systematic; lowers cognitive load
explain causes / effects	Cause & Effect	makes causal chains visible (SSP.05)
put events in order / show change	Timeline / Sequence	builds chronological reasoning (SSP.05)
brainstorm or connect ideas	Concept Web	activates prior knowledge; shows relationships
summarize a text or source	Main Idea & Details	separates the central idea from support
activate prior knowledge & track learning	KWL	metacognition; frames inquiry
learn a key term deeply	Frayer	deep vocabulary processing
analyze a primary source	HIPPO / OPTIC	disciplinary sourcing (SSP.01–02)
make and defend a claim	CER	claim + evidence + reasoning (SSP.04)
weigh two sides / a decision	T-Chart or Problem–Solution	structures evaluation
capture the basics of an event	5 Ws	ensures full coverage
connect a national event to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	our signature local-to-national move

Reproducible — you may copy these pages for classroom use.

Part 1 — Reusable Blank Organizers (all subjects, all units)

Content-agnostic blanks. Print as many as you need; use across any standard or subject.

Venn (3) / Triple T-Chart — Compare THREE

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Comparing three people, groups, or ideas. Use the columns for each item and note shared traits in your notes.

Item A	Item B	Item C
Trait / criterion 1		
Trait / criterion 2		
Trait / criterion 3		
Trait / criterion 4		

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

T-Chart — Two Sides / Pros & Cons / Before-After

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Two categories to sort or weigh: benefits vs costs, pros vs cons, before vs after, cause vs effect. Fast, low-floor entry point for comparison.

[illegible]

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Compare & Contrast Matrix — Items × Criteria

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Comparing several items across the SAME set of criteria. Reduces cognitive load by making the comparison systematic.

Criterion	Item 1	Item 2	Item 3

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Cause & Effect — Causal Chains

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Task asks “what caused...?”, “what were the effects/consequences of...?” Makes causal reasoning visible (builds SSP.05).

Cause	→	Effect
	→	
	→	
	→	

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Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Timeline / Sequence — Chronology

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Ordering events or tracing change over time. Builds chronological reasoning (SSP.05).

Date / order	Event	Why it mattered

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Concept Web — Connect & Brainstorm

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Activating prior knowledge or showing how ideas relate to a central concept. Great as a pre-reading or review move.

Central idea	Connected idea	How it connects

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Main Idea & Details — Summarize

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS
Pulling the central idea and its support from a text or source. Separates the big idea from the evidence.

MAIN IDEA

Detail	Detail	Detail

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KWL — Activate & Track Learning

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Start of a standard: what students Know / Want to know; end: what they Learned. Builds metacognition and frames inquiry.

K — what I Know	W — what I Want to know	L — what I Learned

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5 Ws — Cover the Basics of an Event

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Making sure students capture who/what/when/where/why of an event before analysis.

Question	Answer
Who?	
What?	
When?	
Where?	
Why?	

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Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Problem & Solution — Evaluate Responses

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Analyzing a problem and the responses to it (e.g., a policy or reform). Structures evaluation.

Problem	Proposed solution	Result / evaluation

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Framer Model — Deep Vocabulary

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Learning a key term deeply (definition, characteristics, examples, non-examples).

Definition (own words)	Characteristics

Examples	Non-examples

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CER — Build an Argument

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Any “make a claim / defend / argue” task. Claim + two pieces of evidence + reasoning (builds SSP.04).

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

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HIPPO — Analyze a Primary Source

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS	
Analyzing a photo, cartoon, map, or document (builds SSP.01–SSP.02). Pair with OPTIC for visuals.	
H-I-P-P-O	Prompt / notes
H — Historical context	
I — Intended audience	
P — Purpose	
P — Point of view	
O — Outside connection	

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★ Tennessee Connection — Local ↔ National

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Whenever a standard has a Tennessee tie: link the national event to our state/community and say why the local story matters. This local-to-national move is a HistoryHack signature — use it often.

The national event / idea	Our Tennessee (or local) connection	Why the local story matters

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Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Part 2 — Unit 1 Ready-to-Use Organizers (pre-labeled, best-fit)

Each is matched to the standard whose task it best fits, with a short note on why. Tennessee connections are flagged.

This standard weighs the impact of the Homestead Act & Transcontinental Railroad. A T-chart makes the trade-off explicit: settlers/railroads gained; American Indian nations bore the costs.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

George Jordan of Williamson County — a Buffalo Soldier (9th U.S. Cavalry, Medal of Honor) — anchors this westward-expansion standard to our own community.

US.02 — Federal Indian Policy Over Time (Cause & Effect / Sequence)

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

The standard lists policies that built on one another. A cause→effect flow shows how each policy led to the next: reservations → assimilation → boarding schools → the Dawes Act (1887).

Cause	→	Effect
	→	
	→	
	→	

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Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

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Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

US.03 — End of Reconstruction to Plessy (Timeline)

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

This standard is a sequence of turning points. A timeline makes the chronology and cause/effect clear: 1876 election → Compromise of 1877 → Jim Crow & disenfranchisement → Plessy v. Ferguson (1896).

Date / order	Event	Why it mattered

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US.04 — Farmers vs. Wage Earners vs. Industrial Capitalists (Matrix)

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

The standard names the economic difference among three groups. A 3-column matrix compares them across the same criteria (work, power, wealth, political voice).

Criterion	Farmers	Wage earners	Industrial capitalists
Kind of work			
Economic power			
Political voice			
Biggest challenge			

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Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

US.05 — Captains of Industry vs. Robber Barons (T-Chart)

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

The SAME business leaders can be read two ways. A T-chart makes students weigh the evidence for each lens before judging.

[illegible]

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Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

US.06 — Industrial Centers by Industry (Matrix)

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

The standard asks students to LOCATE cities and connect them to industry. A city × industry matrix organizes the comparison.

City	Known for (industry)	Why here (geography)
Boston		
Chicago		
New York City		
Pittsburgh		
San Francisco		

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Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

